Members: Sarah, Lauren, Karen

Topic: How does inadequate public transportation in Chicago's transit deserts contribute to unequal access to jobs and economic mobility?

- In Roseland, IL
- Access to employment/economic opportunities

Refined question:

Research/information needed:

- Transit access data
- Economic data
-

Next tasks:

Help needed:

Sources:

- https://cnt.org/sites/default/files/publications/CNT_TransitDesertsCookCounty_0.pdf
- https://minds.wisc.edu/items/6d9d5952-f04d-467f-a718-e94649431479
- https://cmap.illinois.gov/news-updates/travel-patterns-in-economically-disconnected-area-clusters
- Transit availability index
- Income and employment data from census

Proposal Criteria

- 1 page
- Topic
- Describe the issue and how it relates to sustainability
- Research question/problem statement
- Analytical/perspective approach
- At least 2 sources

Sustainable Urban Transport - Group Project Proposal

Sarah Spitzer, Karen Huss, Lauren Hayman

Topic: Transit deserts and how they impact the economy and job opportunity in Chicago.

Chicago is a city with many transit deserts, areas which access to public transit is difficult and inconvenient to use. This harms sustainability as when transit is unavailable people will turn to using cars instead.

Without reliable access to transit, people are not able to have reliable access to better jobs than those available in their area or resources such as grocery stores and hospitals. This cuts off communities which have already been historically disinvested in and disenfranchised from opportunities that could improve economic outlooks for residents. Creating better access to transit could assist in lifting individuals out of poverty and creating communities that are more economically healthy and sustainable.

Research Question: How does inadequate public transportation in Chicago's transit deserts contribute to unequal access to jobs and economic mobility?

This report will primarily be analyzing the transit desert present in Roseland, IL. It will be focused on discussing how lack of access to public transit creates unequal access to jobs and contributes to economic stagnation.

Current efforts the city is taking to address this problem will be discussed and used to show how access in other areas of the city can be improved. The effort in this case is the CTA Red Line expansion.

Key Resources:

- Transit Deserts in Cook County
- Transit Deserts Limit Job Prospects
- Red Line Extension (RLE) Redevelopment Project Area
- Out of the Loop: Transit Deserts, Health and Well-Being in Chicago

Economic and transit data from a different more well connected area, such as Lincoln Park, could be beneficial to illustrate the problem and inequality caused by lack of access to public transit.